

“To bridge the skills gap in the industry, we are collaborating with academia to build on their skills and also make them job ready”

Ravi Shankar Ivaturi,
business operations, senior director, Unisys



Why is a tech giant like Unisys investing in a college-level competition for the last twelve years? What's in it for them? And, how did they manage to continue to hire despite the pandemic? **Electronics For You** spoke to **Ravi Shankar Ivaturi, senior director, business operations, Unisys**, to find answers to these questions, and here are the excerpts.

Q. Why is Unisys investing in such a competition?

A. Cloud 20/20 is celebrating its 12th year now, and Unisys has been known for innovation for over 140 years for building high-performance and security-centric solutions for large enterprises and governments. Unisys is a core technology company. When we started in India, there were only a few such companies in the market. So, we believe that as we are a part of the ecosystem, it is our duty to take leadership and bring the ecosystem together to deal with problems and challenges such as business models, changing trends, etc, through innovation.

For starters, we know that in India, we have some brilliant students with brilliant minds. But when it comes to being in a job, we found out that

the students these days are not job ready. To bridge this gap, we thought of coming up with this contest that would serve as a stepping stone for the students into the professional world.

Q. How is the ecosystem contributing to it?

A. Talking about academia, we invite students from engineering colleges to submit project ideas. These teams include professors and students. Shortlisted project ideas are further developed into demonstrable PoCs (proof of concept) with the help of Unisys mentors. Within Cloud 20/20, we have two different programmes for students:

- **SIP (Student Innovation Programme):** Here, we allow the students to define their own problem statements in various fields such as

government, taxation, securing the Internet, securing railways, etc.

- **TIP (Targeted Innovation Programme):** Here, we along with our clients and partners, work on a single (or multiple in some cases) business-specific problem statement. Then it is released in public, and students who want to work on these problem statements can apply.

We get entries from across the country, and the best teams are selected to present their projects in an event held in Bengaluru. The panel that selects these teams comprises our trade bodies, someone from academia, and some of our clients to look at the idea from all the possible angles. This is how all the members in our ecosystem work at different/multiple levels to contribute towards the common goal.

